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Department for Environment, Food & Rural Affairs

Policy paper

Livestock Information Transformation Programme (LITP)

Updated 23 July 2026

Applies to England

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The Livestock Information Transformation Programme (LITP) is a Defra change programme for England, which is introducing new technology to trace livestock movements more quickly and accurately.

Identifying and tracing livestock from their origin to the consumer:

- helps protect animal health
- supports farmers
- keeps our food safe

LITP will replace existing, species–specific traceability systems across England.

The first service to be delivered will be for cattle. This will allow near real–time reporting of livestock movements and the introduction of Bovine Electronic Identification (BEID). This means:

- faster, better–informed decisions on controlling disease outbreaks
- improved data to support animal health and welfare
- stronger assurances on food safety
- enhanced productivity
- smoother trade

Our partners

LITP is funded through the Defra farming budget, with the technology developed in–house by Defra's digital solutions team (DDTS – Digital, Data, Technology and Security).

We're developing the new livestock tracing system in partnership with:

- Animal and Plant Health Agency (APHA) — an executive agency of Defra responsible for animal, plant and bee health
- Rural Payments Agency (RPA), together with the British Cattle Movement Service (BCMS) — delivers operational services, including traceability, to support a thriving farming and food sector

Industry

The Traceability Design User Group (TDUG) is an independent group of over 25 industry, government and academic specialists from across the livestock, equine and meat industries. The group acts as a bridge between industry and government, ensuring the multispecies system meets the needs of both.

Devolved governments

Animal health and traceability policy is devolved. Each nation is developing their own
multispecies traceability services for livestock movements.

- ScotEID (https://www.scoteid.com)
- EIDCymru (https://www.gov.wales/report-and-record-sheep-and-goat-movements-eidcymru)
- Northern Ireland Food Animal Information System (NIFAIS) (https://www.daera-ni.gov.uk/topics/northern-ireland-food-animal-information-system-nifais)

We are working closely with the devolved governments to ensure data from the systems comes together, giving Chief Veterinary Officers and APHA a UK-wide picture of livestock movements to inform disease control and frictionless trade.

Timeline

As new policies are developed and implemented, the programme will:

- establish a new tracing system for cattle to replace the Cattle Tracing System (CTS), to allow reporting of cattle births, movements and deaths
- enhance the LIS system for sheep, goats and deer (Animal Reporting and Movement Service (ARAMS) was replaced in 2022 by the LIS sheep service, to enable digital reporting of movements for sheep, goats and deer)
- introduce Bovine Electronic Identification (BEID)
- expand the new system to include additional species

Bovine Electronic Identification (BEID)

BEID is a system that uses a microchip embedded in the animal's primary or secondary identification tag. Reading this with an electronic reader reduces transcription errors and enables faster, more accurate data capture. Sheep have been electronically tagged using low frequency (LF) technology since 2010.

We expect BEID to be introduced for all newborn calves in England during 2027, using LF technology.

Industry will transition to a fully electronically identified cattle population over time, meaning there will be a period where non–BEID and BEID animals both exist in tandem in the national herd. During this time, animal movements will be able be reported using either BEID reads, barcode scans from passports or visual reading of tags as it is currently done. As a result there is no need to retag the national herd.

Next steps

The first service to be delivered will be for cattle in 2027, replacing the existing CTS. CTS will continue to operate until the service has been rolled out to all cattle keepers.

You do not need to do anything just yet, we'll let you know how and when to register to use the new service. If you report using farm

software, your software provider will let you know if you need to do anything to continue reporting as you do now. If you cannot use technology to report cattle movements, there will be help and support available to make sure you can report in other ways.

Further details on requirements and support available will be provided before the transition of each species to the new service.

Further information

If you want to find out more, you can contact Defra's LITP team by emailing litpcomms@defra.gov.uk.

Related information

- Electronic ID for Cattle mandatory in step forward for UK biosecurity (https://www.gov.uk/government/news/electronic-id-for-cattle-mandatory-in-step-forward-for-uk-biosecurity)

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